THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 8: **The Sermon at Benares (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** teaching through experience	She finds the truth by herself.
2	**(b)** It addresses the sorrow of all mortals	Universal.
3	**(d)** troubled	Describes life.
4	**(d)** acceptance	Accepting.
5	**(a)** wanted her to realise it herself	Gentle teaching.
6	**(a)** Grief does not help the dead or the living.	Only increases pain.
7	**(d)** human beings	Those who die.
8	**(c)** denial to acceptance	From refusal to understanding.
9	**(d)** persistent search	Continuous effort.
10	**(c)** short-lived	Temporary.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	She was in no state to accept (1) so he gave her a task to find the truth herself (1).	1+1
12	Grief is like an arrow that hurts (1) and must be pulled out for peace (1).	1+1
13	To reach all kinds of people (1) and to make the message clear (1).	1+1
14	Every household had lost a member (1) so the condition could never be met (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He did not argue (1). He set a task that revealed truth (1). The method respected her feelings (1).	1+1+1
16	They treat her kindly (1). Each shares a story of loss (1). They teach by their replies (1).	1+1+1
17	Although Kisa Gotami knocked at every door, she found no mustard seed (1). 'Although' shows contrast (1). Subordinate and main clauses (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Kisa Gotami refuses to believe (1). The search shows death in every house (1). She finally buries her son (1).	1+1+1
18	The story gives example (1). The sermon gives principle (1). Together they persuade (1).	1+1+1
	OR: The Buddha gave her a task which taught her the truth (1). 'Which' refers to the task (1). A relative clause is used (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Denial and grief (1). The Buddha's task (1). The search (1). Realisation (1). Peace and burial (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Simple narrative (1). Emotional appeal (1). Universal truth (1). Indirect teaching (1). Memorability (1).	2+2+1
20	Death is certain (1). Grief is useless (1). Arrow of sorrow (1). Path to peace (1). Compassion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Introduction (1). Buddha's view (1). Kisa Gotami's change (1). Modern relevance (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Kisa Gotami got medicine from the Buddha; he asked her for **a handful of mustard seed** from a house where no one had died.
- Mistaking the sermon for a magical cure; it teaches that **death comes to all** and no house is free of it.
- Saying Kisa Gotami was cruel or foolish; she is a grieving mother who, after her search, is **enlightened** and becomes a disciple.
- Mixing up the place: the lesson is the Buddha's first sermon at **Benares**, preserved as a text on the nature of suffering.
- Not stating the final message: *life is full of suffering and death*, and peace comes from giving up grief and attachment.
- Spelling slips: *Kisa Gotami, sermon, mustard, Sakyamuni, enlightenment*; and quoting the Buddha without quotation marks.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 8: **The Sermon at Benares (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** acceptance brings calm	Equanimity.
2	**(a)** excess attachment leads to suffering	Buddhist idea.
3	**(a)** she accepts her loss	Acceptance.
4	**(d)** universal truth	A general truth.
5	**(a)** The Mustard Seed	It centres on the seed.
6	**(d)** Because every house had known death, she found no seed.	Because shows cause.
7	**(c)** his gentle handling of the grieving mother	He guides with care.
8	**(a)** reverent and calm	Respectful.
9	**(c)** serene wisdom	Calm teaching.
10	**(c)** a narrative with sermon passages	Story plus teaching.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It cannot restore life (1) and damages health and peace (1).	1+1
12	Listen with kindness (1) and guide gently (1).	1+1
13	Her hope turns to understanding (1) and her private grief becomes a shared human grief (1).	1+1
14	Death is part of life's cycle (1) so the wise accept it calmly (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	It is a common household item (1). It stands for ordinary life (1). Its absence from death-free houses shows universal mortality (1).	1+1+1
16	Denial of the grieving mother (1). Acceptance of the wise (1). The Buddha guides from the first to the second (1).	1+1+1
17	The Buddha told her not to weep (1). The command becomes an infinitive (1). Pronouns change (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He is kind to her pain (1). He is wise in his method (1). Together they bring healing (1).	1+1+1
18	Opening with grief (1). Tension of the search (1). Calm resolution (1).	1+1+1
	OR: She came to terms with her loss (1). She did not lose heart in the search (1). Both show attitudes to grief (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	She starts with denial (1). Buddha advises acceptance (1). She learns by experience (1). Final calm (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Benares/Sarnath (1). Ordinary people (1). Universal appeal (1). Simplicity (1). Effect (1).	2+2+1
20	Intro (1). Kisa Gotami (1). Buddha's lesson (1). Practical tips (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting (1). Story (1). Importance of compassion (1). Examples (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

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- Mistaking the sermon for a magical cure; it teaches that **death comes to all** and no house is free of it.
- Saying Kisa Gotami was cruel or foolish; she is a grieving mother who, after her search, is **enlightened** and becomes a disciple.
- Mixing up the place: the lesson is the Buddha's first sermon at **Benares**, preserved as a text on the nature of suffering.
- Not stating the final message: *life is full of suffering and death*, and peace comes from giving up grief and attachment.
- Spelling slips: *Kisa Gotami, sermon, mustard, Sakyamuni, enlightenment*; and quoting the Buddha without quotation marks.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 8: **The Sermon at Benares (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** calm and compassionate	Peace and kindness.
2	**(a)** loving and persistent	She loved and searched.
3	**(d)** her suffering is shared by all	Universal loss.
4	**(c)** the mother's attachment	Her love.
5	**(c)** all humankind	Universal.
6	**(c)** ripe fruit, earthen vessels and an arrow	Ripe fruit in danger of falling, potter's vessels that break, and the arrow of grief.
7	**(d)** She was directed to the Buddha by the villagers.	Past passive.
8	**(c)** sharp pain that must be removed	Grief pierces.
9	**(b)** As ripe fruits are in danger of falling, so mortals are always in danger of death.	He uses the ripe fruit that is soon to fall.
10	**(c)** She said that she could not find a house.	Backshift.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It shows acceptance (1) and the end of her denial (1).	1+1
12	He sees that denial must end gradually (1) and uses experience to teach (1).	1+1
13	They are sympathetic (1) and share their own experiences of loss (1).	1+1
14	As the result of understanding (1) and detachment from sorrow (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Life is fleeting (1). It is troubled (1). Death ends all (1).	1+1+1
16	Grief is natural (1). Too much grief damages health (1). The Buddha teaches balance (1).	1+1+1
17	Sympathy with suffering (1). Compassionate (1). Compassionately (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Everyone faces loss (1). Acceptance eases grief (1). Compassion is universal (1).	1+1+1
18	Death spares none (1). All are equal before it (1). So there should be fellow-feeling (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Listen without judging (1). Share kind words (1). Gently remind of life's cycle (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Date (1). Her appearance (1). Her request (1). Your response (1). Reflection (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Setting (1). Character (1). Loss (1). Learning (1). Ending (1).	2+2+1
20	Format (1). Her report (1). Buddha's comfort (1). Her thanks (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Message (1). Method (1). Language (1). Relevance (1). Judgement (1).	2+2+1

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